

CLASS :
EXAM NO :

TIME : 3 Hrs
MARKS : 80

Reading Comprehension

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow

1. Read the following passage:

Major Somnath Sharma was born on 31 January 1923 in Dadh, Kangra, Himachal Pradesh. He belonged to a family with a rich military legacy. His father, Major General Amar Nath Sharma, had served the nation with distinction. Young Somnath was deeply inspired by the valorous tales of the Mahabharata, imparted to him by his grandfather. On 3 November 1947, Major Somnath Sharma and his D Company of 90 soldiers defended Badgam against 500 infiltrators. Despite being heavily outnumbered and injured, he continued to lead his men with unmatched bravery. His famous last words were, 'I shall not withdraw an inch but will fight to the last man and the last round.' He was posthumously awarded the Param Vir Chakra, becoming India's first recipient of this highest gallantry award.

Questions:

- a) In which year was Major Somnath Sharma born? (1 mark)
- b) What inspired young Somnath in his childhood? (1 mark)
- c) How many soldiers were under Major Somnath's command in D Company? (1 mark)
- d) What were Major Somnath Sharma's last words that showed his determination? (1 mark)
- e) Which prestigious award did Major Somnath Sharma receive posthumously? (1 mark) [5 marks]

Writing

Write in proper format with all necessary details

2. You are the Secretary of the Nature Club of your school. Draft a notice in not more than 50 words informing students of Classes 6-8 about a Garden Competition to be held in your school. Include details about date, time, venue, and registration process. [5 marks]

Grammar

Answer all parts

3. a) Fill in the blank with the correct form of adverb: The soldiers fought _____ (brave)

against the enemy. (1 mark)

b) Convert the following sentence from active to passive voice: Major Somnath Sharma led his company with courage. (1 mark)

c) Fill in the blank with the correct future tense form: Tomorrow, we _____ (visit) the National War Memorial. (1 mark)

d) Identify the adverb in the sentence and state its type: Mrs. Jones carefully planted tiny flowers between the stones. (1 mark)

e) Rewrite in passive voice: Encyclopedia solved the mystery before dinner. (1 mark) [5 marks]

Literature

Answer with reference to the context

4. Read the extract and answer the questions:

'My next-door neighbour, Mrs. Jones,
has got a garden full of stones:

A crazy path, a lily pond,
a rockery and, just beyond

A sundial with a strange device,

which Mrs. Jones thinks rather nice.'

a) What are the features of Mrs. Jones' garden mentioned in the extract? (2 marks)

b) What does the word 'crazy' suggest about the path in the garden? (1 mark)

c) Pick out an example of rhyming words from the extract. (1 mark)

d) What literary device is used in 'garden full of stones'? (1 mark) [5 marks]

5. Read the extract and answer the questions:

'Encyclopedia's father was Chief of Police. Everyone thought that he must be the smartest police chief in the country. Chief Brown was smart and quick. He didn't sit around and worry. When he came up against a case he couldn't solve, he acted at once. He cleared his desk, put on his hat, and went home to dinner. Encyclopedia solved the case for him before dinner was over.'

a) Who was Encyclopedia's father and what was his profession? (1 mark)

b) What did Chief Brown do when he couldn't solve a case? (2 marks)

c) Why didn't Chief Brown tell everyone about his son's abilities? (1 mark)

d) What was Encyclopedia's real name? (1 mark) [5 marks]

6. Answer ANY FOUR of the following questions in 30-40 words each:

a) Why does the speaker in 'A Concrete Example' think Mrs. Jones plants flowers with a pin? (2.5 marks)

b) What was Major Somnath Sharma's response when asked to withdraw from Badgam? (2.5 marks)

c) How did Encyclopedia decode the four-word message left by Nolan? (2.5 marks)

d) Describe the Battle of Badgam and its significance. (2.5 marks)

e) What does the title 'A Concrete Example' mean in the context of the poem? (2.5 marks) [10 marks]

7. Answer ANY ONE of the following questions in 100-120 words:

a) Major Somnath Sharma displayed extraordinary courage and leadership during the Battle of Badgam. Discuss his qualities that make him a true hero and how his sacrifice saved Srinagar for India.

OR

b) Encyclopedia Brown was a young detective who helped his father solve difficult cases. Write a character sketch of Encyclopedia Brown highlighting his unique abilities, his relationship with his parents, and why he kept his detective work secret. [5 marks]

SUMMARY OF PAPER GENERATION

Section Reading Comprehension: Reading Comprehension | Total Marks: 5

Section Writing: Writing | Total Marks: 5

Section Grammar: Grammar | Total Marks: 5

Section Literature: Literature | Total Marks: 25